

an electronic device as a brick. And usually, this is the point of no return - unless, of course, you are an expert at this and can flash your device with original firmware again (and that might even win you your original warranty back). This hazard applies to almost all devices, and is the main leverage the big corporations have to keep you from hacking into your device. But the most important thing is, do not hack if you're not confident. You must be ready to face any problems that arise, along with the obvious perks that come with hacking into a mobile device.

The disadvantages of hacking, a device by device coverage:

1) Android

Android, we know, is amongst the most hack-happy of systems. Still, as evidence suggests, Google is not really fond of the people who indulge in "rooting" their devices - as is evident by the fact that they recently blocked rooted devices from using the video rental service from Google Play. Not that this is relevant in India, we don't even have legitimate access to the service! Apart from that, there are also some serious risks with respect to the functionality of the device. With the popularity, and hence the market share, of Android devices increasing by the day, it was only a matter of time before malicious programs made their way into the market and as it stands, there are many out there now. There are many corrupt rooting software just lurking around the corner, waiting for you to give them a way into your device, giving yourself (and by extension, them) superuser privileges, and then leaving it to them to make your beloved device a brain-dead zombie. A security compromise is amongst the most dangerous possibilities in a smartphone, and with more and more services inclined on making your phone the ultimate all-purpose device, including a payment medium, you'd probably not want that. They say the known devil is better than the unknown one. But, given a choice, why not just stay away from them both?



2) iPhone

Apple is one company that likes to have utter and complete control over its devices, and it is only logical that it despises the people who jailbreak